Southern MN Wrestling Officials Association — Constitution

Article I – Name

The name of this organization shall be the Southern MN Wrestling Officials Association, referred to in this Constitution and the Bylaws as "SMWOA" or "the Association."

Article II – Purpose

The purposes of the Association are:

1. To unite into one professional organization all qualified wrestling officials in southern Minnesota.
2. To provide qualified wrestling officials for schools and wrestling programs in southern Minnesota.
3. To promote uniform interpretation and administration of wrestling rules according to Minnesota State High School League (MSHSL) guidelines.
4. To recruit, train, and mentor new wrestling officials.
5. To promote sportsmanship and high standards of conduct among officials, coaches, and athletes.

Article III – Membership

Membership is open to wrestling officials and supporters of wrestling officiating in southern Minnesota. Detailed requirements for each class are set in the Bylaws.

Section 1. Active Members

Active members are MSHSL-registered wrestling officials who meet the Association's annual requirements. Only Active members may hold office.

Section 2. Apprentice Members

Apprentice members are new officials, or candidates working toward MSHSL registration, who are being trained and mentored by the Association.

Section 3. Honorary / Life Members

Honorary / Life members are retired officials recognized for distinguished service to the Association.

Article IV – Officers, Executive Board, and Selection

Section 1. Officers and Executive Board

A. The officers of the Association are the President, Secretary, and Treasurer.

B. The Executive Board consists of the officers, up to five At-Large members, and the immediate Past President.

C. The Executive Board governs the Association between meetings, approves the budget, and sets dues and officiating fees. Officer duties are set in the Bylaws.

Section 2. Nominations and Selection

This Section applies to both officers and At-Large members.

1. **Who nominates:** the Executive Board nominates candidates for any vacant or newly created office.
2. **When:** nominations are made whenever an office becomes vacant or a new position is created.
3. **How selected:** the Executive Board fills the office by majority vote.
4. **Term of office:** officers and At-Large members serve until they resign or are removed by a majority vote of the Executive Board.
5. **Term limits:** none.
6. **Taking office:** a new officer or At-Large member assumes their duties immediately upon selection.
7. **Vacancies:** the Executive Board fills any vacancy under this Section.

Article V – Meetings

Section 1. Schedule

The President sets the schedule of regular meetings and the Annual Meeting. The Secretary distributes the schedule to members before the season begins.

Section 2. Special Meetings

Special meetings may be called by the President or a majority of the Executive Board. The President shall call a special meeting upon the written request of 20% of Active members. Members receive at least 7 days' notice, and only business named in the notice may be acted on.

Section 3. Quorum

A majority of the Executive Board is a quorum for Board meetings.

Article VI – Voting Privileges

A. Only members of the Executive Board may vote. Each has one vote; proxy voting is not allowed.

B. The President votes as a full member of the Executive Board.

C. All other members may attend meetings and speak but may not vote.

Article VII – Parliamentary Authority

Questions of procedure shall be decided according to the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order, except where this Constitution or the Bylaws provide otherwise.

Article VIII – Amendments to the Constitution

A. Any Active member in good standing or the Executive Board may propose an amendment in writing to the Secretary.

B. The Secretary shall send the exact text of the proposed amendment to all members at least 30 days before the meeting where it will be voted on.

C. An amendment is adopted by a two-thirds vote of the Executive Board. Only Executive Board members may vote on amendments.

D. Amendments take effect immediately on adoption unless the motion states a later date.

Article IX – Amendments to the Bylaws

A. Amendments to the Bylaws may be proposed only by the Executive Board.

B. A proposed amendment is adopted by a majority vote of the Executive Board.

Adoption

Adopted by the membership of the Southern MN Wrestling Officials Association on __October 8, 2026_____.

President: __Matt Sogla_____

Secretary: __Bill Olson_____